

2.1 Unit description

Overview

Students must choose **one** physical topic and **one** human topic from the four topics offered in this unit.

Physical topics

- **Topic 1: Extreme Weather**, with its increasing ferocity and frequency, fascinates some people and threatens many others.

OR

- **Topic 2: Crowded Coasts** reveals how increasing development is testing our ability to manage these valued environments.

Human topics

- **Topic 3: Unequal Spaces** explores the causes and consequences of rural and urban disparities and how to manage them.

OR

- **Topic 4: Rebranding Places** focuses on how we need to re-image and regenerate rural and urban places, using appropriate strategies.

Topics

Fieldwork, research and practical work are all seen as a part of the wider investigation process. They form an intrinsic part of each of these topics and this will be reflected in their assessment by examining various parts of the geographical enquiry sequence.

The physical topics pose questions which explore how we might best manage some of the challenges we face from the natural world, while the human topics focus on our need to better manage rural and urban places in the 21st century. They give students the opportunity to look at issues at a local or small scale, relating these to their own lives and experiences as well as comparing their research areas to a wider world context.